

FAQs

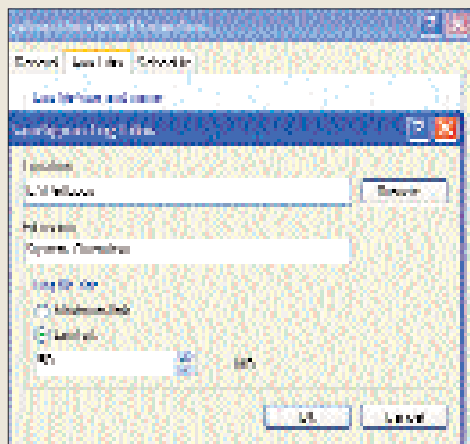
IRQ Locking

Q. I am unable to install the SBLive CT4830 sound card in Windows 2000, but the same hardware works fine in Windows 98. I think the problem lies in the IRQ sharing. I wish to know how I should lock the IRQ for my sound card.

Another problem is that whenever I burn a CD, it gets burned at a maximum speed of 8X, even if the CD supports 24X. If I try to burn the CD at a speed exceeding 8X, it gives an error message saying, "Buffer under run". Why is that so?

Tamal

A To manage IRQ settings for the sound card, right-click on My Computer and go to **Manage > Device Manager**. In the right pane of the window, double-click on Sound, Video and Game controllers. Now right-click on the appropriate sound card driver, and select **Properties > Resources**. Here you can change the IRQ settings for the device. To manually set the IRQ settings, first



Resolve resource sharing conflicts by changing the IRQ settings

un-select 'Use automatic settings'. Under Resource Type, select IRQ and hit Change Setting. Now select the IRQ you wish to bind the sound card with.

The hard disk is unable to provide data to the CD-Writer at the speed that it is required to. This may occur due to many reasons—the hard disk maybe slow, or other applications might also be accessing the hard disk at the same time, or the data might be fragmented, or CPU utilisation by other programs maybe very high. To reduce such errors, use such tools as scandisk and defrag. Try not to run other applications while your CD is burning.

It is also possible that you maybe using an early version of a CD-Writer that does not support buffer under run protection. Hence, it maybe time to buy one of the latest models that support it.

Locking files in a Safe

Q. I wish to know how to password protect my important files and folders so that no one can peek into them?

Brajesh Manohar

A There are many utilities such as Secure Files 2.8, FileVault 2.7, bProtected 2003, noDelete 1.51, etc. to achieve this. Secure Files is one of the best. With this utility the files remain protected even if the application is not running. Add the files to be protected, add the password and close the application. That's it! The files are protected. They can only be retrieved after you start the application and provide your password. As soon as you stop the application from running, all the files



Password protect your documents, using Secure Files 2.8

marked for protection just vanish from their locations. They are visible only when the application is running. It also has an icon, which when pressed, clears the recent file list.

DLL file missing

Q. My Windows 98 SE PC has an Intel 815 motherboard and a PIII 933 processor. After updating the audio driver for my motherboard, I found that it is throwing the following error message at start-up – "Error starting program; a required .dll file - DEC2MIME.DLL not found." Due to this missing .dll file, the startup programs such as MusicMatch, Norton AntiVirus, Task Scheduler, Intel active monitor do not appear on the system tray and task bar. The programs work fine when activated, using the desktop icons.

S.S.Samanta

A The missing .dll file—DEC2MIME.DLL—is actually a Symantec decomposer file, which belongs to one of the recently installed Symantec products. What you can do is reinstall that Symantec product. It should solve your problem and your system tray icons will reappear.

installed Mandrake 8.2 without any problem whatsoever. When I tried to install Red Hat Version 7, I got a message indicating that the disk space is not enough. 256 MB for Swap, 4.5 GB for Root (/), and 1.2 GB for home. When I tried to install Red Hat 9.1, the system hangs after 7 per cent of the installation. At my workplace, the same version installed itself smoothly without any glitches. Will you kindly help me?

G.Harish

A Do make sure that your distribution

is indeed Redhat 9.1. The Red Hat site lists Red Hat 9.0 as its latest stable distro. Running Red Hat 9.0 on your system will be quite torturous as the minimum system requirement is 128 MB RAM. The Red Hat 7 installation should work fine (even a Red Hat 8 needs 4 to 5 GB of hard disk space for a typical install). The low disk space warning could be because you allocated separate space to /home but not to the other directories such as /boot, /usr, /etc, and /var. Try allocating just the swap space and the / partition—

don't give a separate /home partition`. Allocating separate space for /home does not really make much of a difference on a home PC as the number of users will be very less.



Send your computing problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC, MIDC, Nerul, Navi Mumbai-400 706, and we may answer it here!